

Introduction to Biblical Greek

Session 6

Introduction to Greek Verbs

Voice

Active voice: The subject produces the action of the verb.

Passive voice: The subject receives the action of the verb.

Middle voice: The subject produces the action of the verb, but is likewise affected (subject participation, affectedness, or involvement).

~~dependent~~

GeosH = unde-fined

Introduction to Greek Verbs

Greek Tenses

Denote 'time' and 'aspect'. , aktionsart

What tenses are the verbs from the English of John 3:16 in?

- 1) loved, (past tense)
gave
- 2) believes (present)
perish
have

Introduction to Greek Verbs

Greek Tenses and Aspect

Greek verbs denote both time and aspect.

Perfective aspect : The action of the verb is thought of as a simple event, without commenting on whether or not it is a process.

Imperfective aspect: The action of the verb is thought of as an ongoing process.

~~imperfect~~

/ continuous

Introduction to Greek Verbs

Verbal Aspect

“The simplest description is *viewpoint*. An author or speaker views an action, event, or state either from the outside or from the inside. The view of an action, event, or state from the outside is called *perfective aspect*, while the view from the inside is called *imperfective aspect*.”

Constantine Campbell, *Basics of Verbal Aspect in Biblical Greek* (Grand Rapids: Zondervan, 2008), 19.

Introduction to Greek Verbs

Verbal Aspect

“It is the way in which the writer regards the action in its context, viewed as a *whole act* (aorist and future), as a *process* (imperfective including present and imperfect in Greek), or as *a state* (perfect and pluperfect).”

Dean Deppe, *An Overview of Greek Grammar*, 22.

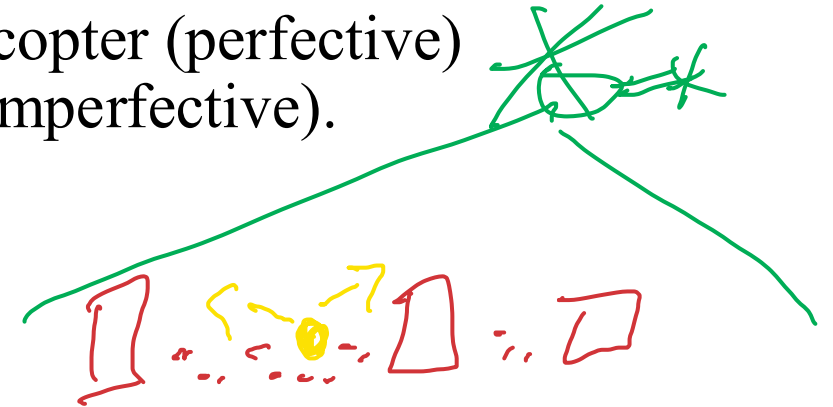
Introduction to Greek Verbs

Verbal Aspect

How the author wants to portray or view the action.

It can either be a *perfective* aspect, or *imperfective* aspect.

E.g., someone viewing a parade from a helicopter (perfective)
vs. someone reporting on the ground (imperfective).



Introduction to Greek Verbs

Greek Tenses

Present: Describes an action that normally occurs in the present.

Future: Describes an action that will occur in the future.

Aorist: For this course, it can be considered as a *simple past tense* in the *indicative mood*.

Perfect: Describes an action that was brought to completion and (whose effects are felt in the present.)

Imperfect: Describes an imperfective action normally occurring in past time.

Pluperfect

ongoing

Introduction to Greek Verbs

Greek Moods / Finite Moods

- Indicative:** Used to describe something that is (as opposed to something that may or might be.)
- Subjunctive:** Used when a verb expresses a possibility, or probability.
- Optative:** It is the mood of “wish.” Whereas the subjunctive is one step removed from reality, the optative is two.
- Imperative** Used when making a command, or urgent request.

Sit!

Introduction to Greek Verbs

Greek Moods / Non-finite Moods

Infinitive: It is a (verbal noun). Has tense and voice, but no person and number.

Participle: It is a (verbal adjective), sharing characteristics of both a verb and an adjective. Has tense and voice, (number, case and person.)

to teach
to + verb

-ing
all the believing ones

9:16 pm

has
pas
every

Past time
Imperfect
Perfect

Introduction to Greek Verbs

Greek Tenses: (Aorist Indicative) Active

From ἀγαπάω to ἠγάπησεν

John 3:16

Regular → talk - ed
Irregular → spoke
X spoke

Augment

ἐ - ἰ

Stem

ἀγαπα

Tense formative (σα)

- σε

Personal ending

- (ν)

- 1) (αω) = η
- 2) (εω) = η
- 3) (οω) = ω

Contract verb

*Contract verbs like ἀγαπάω (άω, έω, and όω) lengthen their contract vowel before the tense formative.

Introduction to Greek Verbs

Aorist active personal endings

Try conjugating the other forms of ἀγαπάω.

	Singular	Plural
First person	—	μεν
Second person	ς	τε
Third person	ε(v)	ν

Final

Example
ἐποίησεν
ποίησεν
ἐποίησεν

Augment ε {

Introduction to Greek Verbs

The verb ἀγαπάω (to love)

Singular

Plural

First person

^{Stem}
ἠγάπησα (I loved)

ἠγαπήσαμεν (we loved)

Second person

ἠγάπησας (you loved)

ἠγαπήσατε (you all loved)

Third person

ἠγάπησεν (he/she/it loved)

ἠγάπησαν (they loved)

Aug Stem tense formative
ζ - πιστευ - ον

Personal ending

Introduction to Greek Verbs

Trying conjugating πιστεύω:

	Singular	Plural
First person	—	μεν
Second person	ς	τε
Third person	— (ν)	ν

Introduction to Greek Verbs

The verb πιστεύω (to believe)

	Singular	Plural
First person	ἐπίστευσα	ἐπιστεύσαμεν
Second person	ἐπίστευσας	ἐπιστεύσατε
Third person	ἐπίστευσεν	ἐπίστευσαν

Introduction to Greek Verbs

Aug stem formation
σ
ε
ζ σ χ ε υ
χ

What about ἐχῶ?

The verbal root of ἐχῶ is *σεχ. In the present the σ is replaced by the rough breathing. But because the Greeks did not like the two aspirate sounds of the rough breathing and the χ in a row, the rough breathing deaspirates to a smooth breathing (*σεχ → ἐχ → ἐχ → ἐχῶ).

William Mounce, *Basics of Biblical Greek* (Grand Rapids: Zondervan, 2019), 237.

Introduction to Greek Verbs

Preparation for Exam 3:

- Definitions of:
 - Conjunctions and prepositions.
 - Three Greek voices.
 - Two verbal aspects.
 - Five Greek tenses.
 - Six Greek moods.
- Core vocabulary 3.
- Forms of ἀγαπάω in the five Greek tenses.
- Conjugations of ἀγαπάω and πιστεύω in their aorist, active, indicative forms.

4 finite
2 non-finite

to